

Complete Denture — Clinic Checklist

Cake primary → Acrylic tray → Green stick ×5 → ZOE final → Wax rim → Try-in → Delivery

Get the DenZU app — your chairside dental companion



Open DenZU App



Dr Aalaa Fahiem



Playlist

0 **V0 Patient selection** exam + signature

1 **V1 Primary impression** (Cake)

L **Lab:** primary cast + acrylic tray

2 **V2 Border molding** (5 sticks) + ZOE final

L **Lab:** master cast + wax rim

3 **V3 Jaw relation** (VDO + CR)

L **Lab:** teeth setting

4 **V4 Try-in** + approval

5 **V5 Delivery** + recall 24h / 1wk

A Abbreviations glossary

VDO	Vertical Dimension of Occlusion — teeth together
CR	Centric Relation — repeatable guided jaw closure
ZOE	Zinc Oxide Eugenol — final wash material
TMJ	Temporomandibular Joint + mouth opening
U / L	Upper / Lower arch
ant / post	Anterior / Posterior
CI I / II / III	Ridge relation classification
Freeway	Rest-minus-occlusion gap, 2–4 mm
Post-dam	Posterior palatal seal area
S / M / F–V	Phonetic checks (gap / lips meet / edge on lip)

1 Shopping list + Patient selection

- ☐ **Stock trays U+L metal** (2 sizes) — try empty first
- ☐ **Cake + Green stick ×5** (enough per case) + **ZOE paste**
- ☐ **Cold-cure acrylic + wax spacer**, pink wax ×2, wax knife — **no shellac**
- ☐ **Ruler / shade / articulating paper**, gloves, blue pen
- ☐ **Good case:** firm rounded ridges, U-arch, **Class I**, cooperative, old successful wearer
- ☐ **Avoid:** knife-edge / flabby / tori, severe CI II/III, gagger, uncontrolled diabetes

Trick: palpate ridge — flabby = loose carpet → plan **mucostatic**, tell supervisor.

2 V1 — Primary impression (Cake)

- ❑ Try tray empty: **2–3 mm clearance**, cover **hamular notch (U)** / **retromolar pad (L)**, **no rock**
- ❑ Soften cake, load **bulk** — seat **U back→front** / **L front→back**
- ❑ **Functional trim**: cheek pull, **Ahh**, tongue side-to-side — **hold still, snap out**
- ❑ Check: **full sulcus, no drags/voids** — **pour immediately**

TRAY + 2–3 mm

U: hamular | L: retromolar

Tray coverage — 2–3 mm clearance all around



Border cross-section — rounded, matte, 3–4 mm

Lab slip: primary cast + acrylic tray, **2 mm spacer + 4 stops**, borders 2 mm short.

3 V2 — Border molding (5 sticks) + ZOE

- ❑ Tray **stable on 4 stops, 2 mm short**, handle free of lip
- ❑ Temper **2–3 cm at 50–55°C**, seat **5–10 s** per section
- ❑ **Trim per zone**: U labial **pucker/smile**; U buccal **cheek out + half-open**; U post **wide + Ahh**; L labial **pucker**; L buccal **half-open + side**; L lingual

tongue-to-lip / swallow-protrude; retromolar wide

- ❑ Right border = **rounded, matte, 3–4 mm** — shiny/thin = **add**
- ❑ **Lip-pull holds = seal** — show supervisor **before wash**
- ❑ **ZOE: dry field, thin mix, light pressure on stops, 5–6 min** — **uniform, seal visible**

Fail: hard pressure, wet field, thick mix, overheated stick.

4 V3 — Jaw relation (VDO + CR)

- ❑ Rim: **U 20–22 mm ant / 6–8 post; L 16–18 mm ant**, post at **retromolar pad**, **width 8–10 mm**
- ❑ Rim **parallel to ala-tragus + pupils**
- ❑ **VDO = rest – 2–4 mm** — S→**1–2 mm gap**, M→**lips meet**, F/V→**edge on lip**
- ❑ **CR:** chair 45°, lower flat + upper V-notch, guide back, close gently **×3 same = true CR**
- ❑ Mark **midline / smile / canine / lip** — shade **natural**



VDO = rest vertical dimension minus 2–4 mm freeway

5 V4 — Try-in (ordered check)

- ❑ **Retention:** U holds half-open, L holds on tongue move
- ❑ **VDO + freeway** same as V3

- ☐ **CR repeatable, no slide**
- ☐ **Balanced:** posteriors touch, **no anterior touch**, smooth glide
- ☐ **Esthetics:** midline ≤ 2 mm, smile line, lip support
- ☐ **Phonetics:** 60–70, Fifty-five, M
- ☐ **Mirror + photo approval + supervisor OK** for processing

Off? Re-take bite — extra visit < remake.

6 V5 — Delivery + Recall + Complaints

- ☐ **Smooth polished borders**, bilateral contacts, trim lightly + **polish**, frena free
- ☐ Wear **all day wk1**, night off after wk1; **soft food small, both sides**; read aloud 2 wks
- ☐ **Soap not toothpaste**, soak nightly, **recall 24h + 1wk** even if fine
- ☐ Adjust: **pencil transfer** → **remove 0.5 mm** → **polish** — wear **4–6h before recall**

Says	Cause → Fix
U loose laugh	short seal → check post-dam
L lifts eating	long lingual / high bite → shorten, balance
Ulcer / gag	long border / dam → trim 1 mm
Click / sunken	VDO high / low → verify freeway